Interview notes: Sample Co front desk (made-up)

Present: front desk lead, owner, analyst.

The front desk takes bookings by phone and writes them in a paper diary, then types them into a spreadsheet at the end of the day. About 30 bookings a day. Double bookings happen about twice a week.

The owner wants a text reminder the day before each booking. Customers should be able to cancel by replying. The owner must see the next day's list by 7 pm.

Payment is taken at the desk. Deposits are needed for jobs over $200. Refunds need the owner's approval.

Constraint: must work on the existing desktop PC. Budget is small. Go-live wanted within six weeks.

Open questions: who corrects a booking after the diary is closed? What happens when two staff edit one booking at once? How long must booking records be kept?